



at home and Down Under, put stalwarts Virat Kohli and Rohit under the scanner months after they retired on a high from the shortest format of the game following the T20 World Cup triumph.

Youngsters take over

The star duo's woes against spin bowling at home were emblematic of India's festering malaise, epitomised by the humbling loss to the Kiwis. Rohit's men were handed a jolt in a defeat to England in spin-friendly conditions in Hyderabad earlier in the year, but the team course-corrected in

relatively benign conditions to clinch the series 4-1 against the visiting 'Bazballers.'

Even as the year ended on a sour note for the Indians, the genius of Jasprit Bumrah, the top wicket-taker in the Border-Gavaskar Trophy, Nitish Kumar Reddy's all-round potential, and Yashasvi Jaiswal's prolific run with the bat were the silver linings.

In limited-overs cricket, the horizons expanded significantly for India with a host of youngsters ushering in the 'GenNext' era. While the side couldn't register a single win

At a crossroads: Demoralising Test defeats against New Zealand and Australia have raised questions over the future of Indian stalwarts Rohit Sharma and Virat Kohli. AFP

in the three One-Day Internationals it played in 2024, losing to Sri Lanka 0-2 away, the T20I brigade lost just two out of 26 matches, ransacking attacks at an average run rate of 9.55 — the highest for a Full Member in the year.

India also registered its highest total in the format — a scarcely